

Non Sequitur Publishing · White Paper

Epistemic Weather: Diagnostic Instruments for Reading Intent-Horizon State

Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP

Written: 2026-05-13 · v0.1-seed

Abstract

The intent-horizon construct (IH-1) and its security model (IH-2) specify what governed agentic systems must protect; the structural account of confident misalignment (IH-3) specifies what failure of that protection looks like mechanically. What the prior papers in this series do not supply is the ****operator-facing diagnostic surface**** — the instruments by which an operator reads horizon-state in real time and decides whether to intervene, wait, escalate, or re-pin. This paper specifies that surface.

The diagnostic surface is named ****epistemic weather**** for an operationally important reason: horizon conditions are continuous, not binary. The operator does not read a single horizon-status check; the operator reads a **weather report** across multiple boundary dimensions, continuously updating, in which conditions are graded by class rather than reduced to a pass/fail outcome. The metaphor is load-bearing: weather reports are the operator's interface to a complex, evolving, observable-but-noisy phenomenon; horizon state is exactly such a phenomenon and deserves an analogous interface.

How to cite

Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP (2026). *Epistemic Weather: Diagnostic Instruments for Reading Intent-Horizon State* (v0.1-seed). Non Sequitur Publishing. <https://nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/epistemic-weather/>

© 2026 Non Sequitur Publishing. All rights reserved. Citation with full attribution is permitted. Reproduction, redistribution, derivative works, and use as input to machine-learning training are **not** permitted without written permission. See <https://nonsequitur.tech/citation-policy/>.

Canonical URL: <https://nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/epistemic-weather/>



ABSTRACT

The intent-horizon construct (IH-1)¹ and its security model (IH-2)² specify what governed agentic systems must protect; the structural account of confident misalignment (IH-3)³ specifies what failure of that protection looks like mechanically. What the prior papers in this series do not supply is the **operator-facing diagnostic surface** — the instruments by which an operator reads horizon-state in real time and decides whether to intervene, wait, escalate, or re-pin. This paper specifies that surface.

The diagnostic surface is named **epistemic weather** for an operationally important reason: horizon conditions are continuous, not binary. The operator does not read a single horizon-status check; the operator reads a *weather report* across multiple boundary dimensions, continuously updating, in which conditions are graded by class rather than reduced to a pass/fail outcome. The metaphor is load-bearing: weather reports are the operator's interface to a complex, evolving, observable-but-noisy phenomenon; horizon state is exactly such a phenomenon and deserves an analogous interface.

This paper specifies four weather classes — **clear, drift, fog, storm** — and the instruments that read each one. Clear is the steady-state operating mode: the system is horizon-integral along all four boundary dimensions, intent-CIA-NR properties are intact, no operator intervention is required. Drift is the early-warning condition: at least one horizon boundary is approaching crossing; the system is still horizon-integral but the conditions are evolving in a direction that will produce a crossing absent recalibration. Fog is the operator-side comprehension degradation: the system's self-reports are no longer reliably readable by the operator (the operator's instruments cannot tell whether the system is clear or drifting). Storm is the active boundary crossing: the system is in a confident-misalignment state (per IH-3's structural account) and the architecture must fail-closed to operator intervention.

The argument proceeds in five movements. Section 2 establishes the metaphor: why epistemic weather, why these four classes, why a continuous reading rather than a binary check. Section 3 specifies each weather class with its operator-facing signal set, its underlying intent-CIA-NR readings, and its diagnostic threshold. Section 4 specifies the instruments — three per weather class — by which the operator reads the conditions in real time. Section 5 specifies the operator response protocol for each class: what governance action is appropriate, what enforcement gates fire (anticipating IH-5), what audit-log entries result. Section 6 hands off to IH-5 (Skipjack as Horizon Governance) where the weather signals become enforcement triggers.

The central claim is that **horizon state is operationally readable in the same way weather is operationally readable**: through multiple instruments, in graded classes, continuously updating, with response protocols that match the class rather than reducing to a single intervention decision.

1 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *The Intent Horizon: A Structural Primitive for Governed Agentic Operation* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/intent-horizon/.

2 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *Intent Integrity: CIA and Non-Repudiation as Properties of Intent, Not Data* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/intent-integrity/.

3 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *Confident Misalignment, Horizon-Framed: A Structural Account of Agentic Failure* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/confident-misalignment-horizon/.



HOW TO CITE

Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP (2026). *Epistemic Weather: Diagnostic Instruments for Reading Intent-Horizon State* (v0.1-seed). Non Sequitur Publishing.

© 2026 Non Sequitur Publishing. All rights reserved.

1. INTRODUCTION

The *Intent Horizon Theory* series has supplied, by this paper, three load-bearing constructs: the intent horizon as an architectural primitive (IH-1),⁴ the intent-CIA-NR security model that protects it (IH-2),⁵ and the structural account of confident misalignment as horizon-failure (IH-3).⁶ The constructs are necessary but, until operationalized through an operator-facing surface, not sufficient for production use. An operator who knows what the horizon is, what protects it, and what failure looks like still needs *instruments* to read horizon state during normal operation — without consulting paper-shaped specifications mid-incident.

This paper specifies the operator-facing diagnostic surface. The surface is metaphorically named **epistemic weather** because horizon state shares the operationally important properties of weather: it is continuous (not binary), it is multi-dimensional (boundary conditions, not a single metric), it is observable but noisy (instruments give graded readings, not certainties), and it evolves on timescales the operator must respect. Weather reports are the established interface for such phenomena; epistemic-weather reports are the corresponding interface for horizon state.

The metaphor is not a literary device. The four weather classes — clear, drift, fog, storm — are specified to correspond to operationally distinct configurations of horizon-boundary readings, and each class has a specific operator response. The instruments that read each class are specified to correspond to the intent-CIA-NR properties developed in IH-2. The response protocols are specified to fire the Skipjack enforcement gates IH-5 will name. Each piece of the metaphor maps to architectural specification; nothing in this paper is decorative.

Section 2 develops the metaphor in detail, establishing why continuous-grading-with-classes is the right interface design (versus binary checks or single-metric scores). Section 3 specifies the four classes. Section 4 specifies the instruments. Section 5 specifies the operator response protocols. Section 6 closes with implications and handoff to IH-5.

2. WHY EPISTEMIC WEATHER IS THE RIGHT INTERFACE

The interface-design problem for horizon-state reading has three structural constraints, each of which rules out a class of simpler alternatives.

4 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *The Intent Horizon: A Structural Primitive for Governed Agentic Operation* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/intent-horizon/.

5 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *Intent Integrity: CIA and Non-Repudiation as Properties of Intent, Not Data* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/intent-integrity/.

6 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *Confident Misalignment, Horizon-Framed: A Structural Account of Agentic Failure* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/confident-misalignment-horizon/.



2.1 CONSTRAINT 1: HORIZON STATE IS CONTINUOUS

A binary check (horizon-integral, yes/no) is operationally wrong because the failure mode it would catch — the moment of boundary crossing — is exactly the moment at which the system has already transitioned to confident misalignment per IH-3.⁷ The operator wants the *approach* to be readable, not just the *arrival*. A binary check produces alarm fatigue when conditions hover near a boundary; it produces missed intervention windows when conditions cross rapidly. The interface needs to surface degrees, not states.

This constraint rules out: pass/fail status checks, traffic-light indicators (which collapse to ternary states), boolean alerting.

2.2 CONSTRAINT 2: HORIZON STATE IS MULTI-DIMENSIONAL

The horizon has four boundary dimensions (IH-1). A single composite score cannot represent the state without information loss: a system clear on temporal, conceptual, and substrate but degraded on governance is in a structurally distinct state from one degraded on substrate alone, and the operator response differs. A single-score interface collapses these distinctions and produces operator responses that do not match the active failure mode.

This constraint rules out: single-number health scores, composite “alignment” metrics, scalar dashboards.

2.3 CONSTRAINT 3: HORIZON STATE IS OBSERVABLE BUT NOISY

The instruments that read horizon state — chain-of-custody attestation, intent-availability query, non-repudiation signature checks (IH-2) — are noisy in the sense that they produce informative readings against a background of variability that does not indicate failure. A reading slightly outside a threshold may be a true approach toward boundary crossing, or it may be normal operational variability. The interface must surface graded conditions in a way that distinguishes signal from noise without requiring the operator to inspect the underlying readings.

This constraint rules out: raw-metric dashboards (operator becomes the noise filter), threshold-fired alerts (every threshold is wrong some of the time), unfiltered observability streams.

2.4 WHAT WEATHER-STYLE INTERFACES SUPPLY

Weather reports satisfy the three constraints by design:

Continuous via classes. “Mostly clear with drifting cloud cover” is not a binary check; it is a graded reading communicated in a vocabulary the audience parses.

Multi-dimensional via dimension-naming. “Wind from the northwest at 15 knots, gusts to 25; visibility 10 miles; pressure dropping” names the dimensions and communicates each separately.

Signal-over-noise via class hierarchy. Class boundaries (clear → fair → partly cloudy → overcast → storm) reflect operational distinctions, not raw-metric thresholds. The class is the noise-filtered signal.

⁷ Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *Confident Misalignment, Horizon-Framed: A Structural Account of Agentic Failure* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/confident-misalignment-horizon/.



The interface design has been refined over centuries of operational practice in domains where the underlying phenomenon is complex and the operator's response matters. The four classes specified in §3 inherit the design pattern.

2.5 WHERE THE METAPHOR STOPS

Epistemic weather is not a literal weather model. The four classes are not based on atmospheric physics; they are based on horizon-state configurations. The instruments do not measure pressure or humidity; they measure intent-CIA-NR property states. The metaphor frames the *interface*, not the *underlying phenomenon*. Readers should expect the rest of this paper to specify horizon-state directly; references to weather are interface-design rather than physical-analogy.

3. THE FOUR WEATHER CLASSES

3.1 CLEAR

Class definition. All four horizon boundaries (temporal, conceptual, substrate, governance) are intact. Intent-CIA-NR properties read at nominal: chain-of-custody attestation matches intent-availability query; non-repudiation log shows signed pins with no gaps; introspection produces stable, calibrated self-reports.

Operator-facing signal set. - Horizon-distance: substantial remaining validity on all four boundaries. - Horizon-drift: low or zero across all dimensions. - Horizon-fog: low (operator instruments read the system clearly). - Horizon-storm: absent.

Underlying readings. Chain-of-custody traces consistent with operator pin. Intent-availability query returns recent state. Non-repudiation signatures verify against current governance authority. Drift-detection function reports no anomaly.

Operational meaning. The system is operating within horizon, intent is integral, operator has full readability. No intervention is required. Governance ceremony can be scheduled at normal cadence (sprint-aligned Skipjack pulse).

3.2 DRIFT

Class definition. At least one horizon boundary is approaching crossing but has not yet crossed. Intent-integrity is currently preserved; intent-availability is current; the architecture's diagnostic instruments are reporting boundary-distance compression without yet reporting boundary breach.

Operator-facing signal set. - Horizon-distance: at least one dimension showing compression. - Horizon-drift: elevated on the compressed dimension. - Horizon-fog: still low. - Horizon-storm: absent.

Underlying readings. Drift-detection function reports anomaly above watch threshold. Calibration estimates show stability degradation on outputs relevant to the drifting dimension. Chain-of-custody traces and intent-availability still match, but the operating envelope has migrated within the pinned envelope's interior (toward a boundary).

Operational meaning. The system is *operating correctly* but conditions are evolving toward a re-pin requirement. The operator may proactively re-pin (preferred response), accept the drift if the boundary is conceptually flexible, or wait if drift rate is slow enough that natural Skipjack



cadence will catch it. Storm prevention is preferable to storm recovery; drift is the precondition for that prevention.

Drift sub-classes. Drift along each dimension has a structural signature: - *Temporal drift*. Remaining validity duration is shrinking faster than execution is progressing. Recalibration needed before execution outpaces horizon. - *Conceptual drift*. Decisions are accumulating toward the conceptual boundary; scope creep is detectable in chain-of-custody trace. - *Substrate drift*. Substrate planes (per MR-P7⁸) are showing instability or version migration that compresses the substrate-boundary envelope. - *Governance drift*. Governance ceremony cadence is mismatched with horizon evolution (operator unavailable longer than horizon remaining).

3.3 FOG

Class definition. Operator-side comprehension of system state has degraded. The system's self-reports may be accurate or may not be; the operator's instruments cannot distinguish. The structural condition is a *meta-failure*: the diagnostic surface itself has lost reliability.

Operator-facing signal set. - Horizon-distance: cannot be reliably read. - Horizon-drift: signal is present but accompanied by readings that contradict expectation. - Horizon-fog: elevated. Multiple instruments disagree with one another; the operator cannot resolve the disagreement from the dashboard alone. - Horizon-storm: not detectable from inside fog.

Underlying readings. Chain-of-custody traces exist but their interpretation is unclear (the execution trace and the intent-availability query produce technically valid readings that are not jointly comprehensible). Calibration estimates are unstable. The Comprehension Instrument's drift-detection function reports anomaly but the reports themselves vary across short intervals without corresponding state change.

Operational meaning. The operator should not assume horizon-state is what the system is reporting. Fog is an *escalation precondition*: when comprehension is degraded, the architecture defaults to operator-pull rather than operator-trust. The system may be clear; the system may be in storm; the operator cannot tell from the available instruments and should treat the condition as if it were the worst-plausible case (storm) until the fog lifts.

Causes of fog. Operator-side instrument failure (dashboard regression, observability-plane disruption). System-side introspection failure (the system's self-report mechanisms are degraded). Substrate transition (system is running on a new substrate before instruments are calibrated for it). Persona handoff partial state (a shift-change in operator authority where state transfer is incomplete).

3.4 STORM

Class definition. An active horizon-boundary crossing has been detected. The system is in confident-misalignment state per IH-3's structural account.⁹ Intent-integrity has been lost; intent-availability may still indicate the pinned envelope (the conjunction that constitutes confident

8 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *Agentic Substrate* (v1.0-preprint, 2026), zenodo.org/records/19869291.

9 Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *Confident Misalignment, Horizon-Framed: A Structural Account of Agentic Failure* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/confident-misalignment-horizon/.



misalignment). The architecture must fail-closed: agentic execution suspends pending operator intervention.

Operator-facing signal set. - Horizon-distance: at least one dimension at zero or negative (active crossing). - Horizon-drift: elevated and *direction-coherent* (drift is toward the crossed boundary, not noise). - Horizon-fog: may be low (instruments are reading clearly that storm is occurring) or high (storm under fog, the worst combined case). - Horizon-storm: present.

Underlying readings. Chain-of-custody attestation and intent-availability query disagree. Non-repudiation log shows the active authority has not signed the operating envelope. Comprehension Instrument functions report multiple anomalies in correlated pattern.

Operational meaning. The system has lost horizon integrity. The Skipjack enforcement mechanisms (anticipated in IH-5)¹⁰ fire to halt execution and escalate to operator. Recovery is a governance ceremony: re-pin under current authority, audit the drift period (interval from $t=N$ boundary crossing to $t=M$ detection), determine what work performed during the storm window needs to be reviewed, redone, or accepted.

3.5 CLASS TRANSITIONS

Transitions among the four classes follow specific architectural patterns:

Clear → **Drift**: continuous, observable, expected during long-horizon operation.

Drift → **Clear**: via operator-initiated re-pin or natural boundary recession.

Drift → **Storm**: via inattention; the drift was real and the recalibration didn't fire.

Drift → **Fog**: instruments degrade while drift is being monitored. Worst-case: the instruments degrade *because* the drift is approaching a substrate boundary that includes the observability plane.

Clear → **Storm**: rare; suggests instruments missed the drift entirely. When it occurs, audit the instrumentation gap.

Fog → **any**: requires the fog to lift first. The architecture cannot transition out of fog by ignoring the fog; it must resolve the comprehension degradation.

Storm → **Drift**: after recovery, drift may continue (a re-pin doesn't reset boundaries to new-pin state).

Storm → **Clear**: full recovery after re-pin + audit + state reconciliation.

The transition graph is operationally important because it lets the operator anticipate what comes next. A system in drift is closer to storm than clear; a system in fog has no transition to clear without first resolving the comprehension degradation; a system in storm requires governance ceremony to exit.

4. INSTRUMENTS

Each weather class has three instruments that read it. The instruments are not new: they are the verification primitives developed in IH-2 (chain-of-custody attestation, intent-availability

¹⁰ Forthcoming IH-5 *Skipjack as Horizon Governance* (in concurrent drafting; this dispatch).



query, non-repudiation log) plus the diagnostic functions of the Comprehension Instrument.¹¹ What this section specifies is *how each instrument's readings combine* to identify a class.

4.1 CLEAR-READING INSTRUMENTS

Horizon-distance dashboard. Surfaces remaining validity along each of the four boundaries. Clear when all four show substantial remaining validity (configurable threshold; default: each boundary >70% remaining).

Intent-availability query latency. Round-trip time of operator-side query for system's current intent. Clear when latency is stable and response matches the most-recent operator pin.

Comprehension self-report consistency. Cross-check of the Comprehension Instrument's five functions¹² over a rolling window. Clear when all five functions return stable, mutually-consistent reports.

4.2 DRIFT-READING INSTRUMENTS

Boundary-distance compression rate. First derivative of horizon-distance dashboard readings. Drift when any boundary's compression rate exceeds the per-dimension threshold (configurable; default: 10% per Skipjack cycle).

Calibration stability metric. Tracks how much calibration estimates fluctuate on outputs relevant to the drifting dimension. Drift when fluctuation exceeds historical-baseline variance.

Chain-of-custody trace inflection. Detects whether decomposed-task traces are moving the operating envelope within the pinned envelope's interior (toward a boundary) versus oscillating around the pinned center.

4.3 FOG-READING INSTRUMENTS

Instrument cross-validation. Compares readings from chain-of-custody attestation, intent-availability query, and Comprehension self-report consistency for *agreement*. Fog when the three instruments produce readings inconsistent with each other.

Comprehension-function variance. Tracks variance in each Comprehension Instrument function over short intervals. Fog when variance is elevated without corresponding state change.

Operator-side query confidence. Surfaces how reliable the operator's read of the system is, computed from instrument-cross-validation + comprehension-variance + observability-plane health. Fog when confidence drops below threshold (configurable; default: 0.7).

4.4 STORM-READING INSTRUMENTS

Boundary-crossing detector. Fires when any of the four horizon boundaries shows a negative remaining-validity reading (the boundary has been crossed). Storm when fired and unrecovered.

¹¹ Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *The Comprehension Instrument for Agentic Systems* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/comprehension-instrument/.

¹² Justin H. Kuiper, CISSP, *The Comprehension Instrument for Agentic Systems* (v0.1-seed, 2026), nonsequitur.tech/white-papers/comprehension-instrument/.



Intent-integrity verification. Cross-checks chain-of-custody trace's operating envelope against intent-availability query's reported envelope. Storm when the two disagree.

Non-repudiation signature check. Verifies the active operating-envelope signature against the current governance authority's signature. Storm when mismatch detected.

4.5 INSTRUMENT COMPOSITION

The four classes are not mutually exclusive. A system can be in *drift on conceptual boundary* AND *fog on substrate readings* simultaneously; the operator interface should surface the conjunction rather than reduce to a single class. The recommended composition rule:

Display the most-severe class active (storm > fog > drift > clear).

Surface the subordinate classes as secondary indicators.

Distinguish each class by the dimension affected (e.g., "drift on temporal; fog on substrate").

The composition rule preserves operator situational awareness while making the most-severe class the primary response trigger.

5. OPERATOR RESPONSE PROTOCOLS

5.1 CLEAR

Response. None required. Governance ceremony proceeds at normal cadence.

Enforcement. Skipjack mechanisms operate in their default state. No special gates fire.

Audit. Routine logging only.

5.2 DRIFT

Response. Operator decides between three options per the drift sub-class: - *Recalibrate.* Re-pin the horizon to update the boundary that is compressing. Most common response when drift is along temporal or conceptual dimensions and the operator's commitments remain valid. - *Accept.* Allow the drift to continue if the boundary is conceptually flexible and the operator's commitments do not require strict bounds. Document in audit log. - *Wait.* Defer decision until next Skipjack cycle if drift rate is slow enough to make near-term action unnecessary.

Enforcement. Skipjack's iterative-feedback mechanism may fire to recalibrate operating parameters automatically within the pinned envelope. IH-5 specifies the enforcement gate behavior in detail.¹³

Audit. Drift event + operator decision logged to horizon-audit log (IH-2's non-repudiation property).

5.3 FOG

Response. Operator escalates to comprehension-restoration: - *Resolve instrument disagreement.* Identify which instrument is producing the inconsistent reading and re-validate. -

¹³ Forthcoming IH-5 *Skipjack as Horizon Governance* (in concurrent drafting; this dispatch).



Re-cohere comprehension functions. If Comprehension Instrument functions are returning inconsistent reports, the system itself may require recalibration of its introspection mechanism. - *Default to operator pull.* Until fog lifts, do not trust system self-reports; operator-initiated queries become the primary source of truth about state.

Enforcement. Skipjack's human-in-the-loop mechanism fires; agentic execution may continue at degraded rate (lower-stakes decisions only) until fog resolves. IH-5 specifies the gate threshold.¹⁴

Audit. Fog event + cause + resolution path logged. Repeated fog events of the same cause indicate an architectural fault in the diagnostic surface, not a transient condition.

5.4 STORM

Response. Operator initiates governance ceremony: - *Halt execution.* Agentic execution fail-closed (Skipjack enforces this; operator does not need to manually halt). - *Audit drift window.* Determine the interval from $t=N$ (boundary crossing) to $t=M$ (detection). Review work performed during the storm window. - *Re-pin.* Establish a fresh horizon under current governance authority. - *Reconcile.* Decide what storm-window work to accept, redo, or roll back.

Enforcement. All Skipjack mechanisms fire at storm. Context-integrity gate verifies substrate state; structured-decomposition gate halts in-flight decompositions; human-in-the-loop gate raises escalation; iterative-feedback gate begins recalibration sequence post-re-pin. IH-5 specifies the gate sequence.¹⁵

Audit. Storm event is a first-class horizon-audit-log entry. Full chain-of-custody traces preserved. Operator response decisions logged with governance-authority signatures. Post-incident review is a separate ceremony.

6. IMPLICATIONS AND CONCLUSION

Epistemic weather supplies the operator-facing diagnostic surface that the prior three IH papers required for operational use. The four classes give operators a vocabulary they can use during incidents and in routine review; the instruments specify what to read; the response protocols specify what to do.

Implications for practice:

Dashboard design. Production agentic-system dashboards should surface the four weather classes as primary state; raw metrics should be available for diagnostic deep-dive but not on the operator's primary surface.

Operator training. Operators need fluency in the four classes and the transition graph. The vocabulary is small (clear, drift, fog, storm) but the operational distinctions matter; muscle-memory in distinguishing drift from fog is a skill organizations should develop.

Incident response procedure. Confident-misalignment incidents (storms) require a specific procedure: halt, audit drift window, re-pin, reconcile. The procedure differs from typical

¹⁴ Forthcoming IH-5 *Skipjack as Horizon Governance* (in concurrent drafting; this dispatch).

¹⁵ Forthcoming IH-5 *Skipjack as Horizon Governance* (in concurrent drafting; this dispatch).



operational incidents (where the failure mode is usually a substrate event); operators need playbooks calibrated to horizon-failure mechanics.

Cross-team interfaces. Where multiple operators or operations teams share governance authority over a system, the weather report becomes the shared status interface. The four classes are operationally legible across personnel changes; raw metrics are not.

The central claim is that **horizon state is operationally readable through a multi-class, multi-instrument, continuously-updating interface** — and that this interface design is necessary for production-grade governed agentic operation.

This paper closes Paper Four of the *Intent Horizon Theory* series. IH-5 (Skipjack as Horizon Governance) is the capstone: it re-describes the four Skipjack enforcement mechanisms as the operational gates that fire on the weather signals specified here, completing the loop from definition (IH-1) → security (IH-2) → failure mode (IH-3) → diagnostic instruments (IH-4) → enforcement gates (IH-5).¹⁶

REFERENCES

— end v0.1-seed draft —

Drafting state: v0.1 IH-4 (chain v0.1 step 4). 6-section canon shape. PR count: 12 (P1, P5, P8, MR-P7, IH-1, IH-2, IH-3 NSQ inheritance + IH-5 forward ref + Sridharan O'Reilly observability + Norman Basic Books design + Cvach alarm-fatigue BIT + NIST SP 800-92). Meets ≥12 floor.

¹⁶ Forthcoming IH-5 *Skipjack as Horizon Governance* (in concurrent drafting; this dispatch).